UNIT 4 + 14 · URBAN SKETCHING FINAL · TIER 3 · 8 POINTS

DA RULES

(OF URBAN SKETCHING)

MICRON ONLY. NO PENCIL!

1. SIT STILL LONG ENOUGH TO OBSERVE

Watch for 2 minutes before your first line.

2. LOOK FOR A "STORY MOMENT"

What's happening? That's your subject.

3. START W/ LARGE SHAPES! NO DETAIL

Story moment first: big, in the middle. Build out.

4. DRAW PEOPLE AS GESTURES, NOT PORTRAITS

Bean body, stick limbs. Show the action.



5. USE LINE WEIGHT TO FAKE DEPTH

Close = thick + dark. Far = thin.

6. BREAK PERSPECTIVE RULES

(strategically) Lean it or bend it if it tells the story.

7. LEAVE STUFF OUT

Not every brick or leaf. Let the edges fade away.

8. DON'T ERASE!

Pen from line one. Nothing to erase.

9. TREAT MISTAKES LIKE THEY BELONG

Wrong line? Draw the right one next to it.

10. EMBRACE SPEED

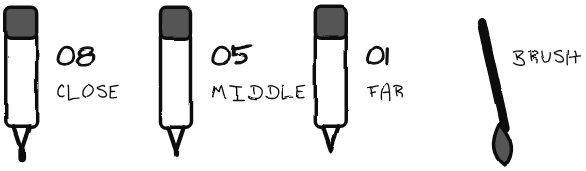
Fast lines look alive. People move, so you move.

11. ADD NOTES OR TINY TEXT

The time, the place, what you heard.

12. LIMITED COLOR POPS

Ink first. 2-3 colors, only where it matters.



Ink, wait, paint. Microns are waterproof once they dry. Give the ink a minute, then add your color pops with watercolor. The numbers in the sketch show where each rule happens.

UNIT 4 + 14 · URBAN SKETCHING FINAL · TIER 3 · 8 POINTS

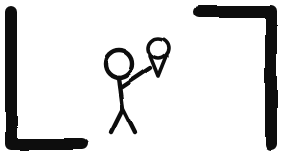
CENTER OUT

(HOW TO BUILD A SKETCH)

Don't draw the whole park. Find the one thing that's **happening**, draw it big in the middle of your page, then let the world grow out around it.

01 FIND THE STORY MOMENT

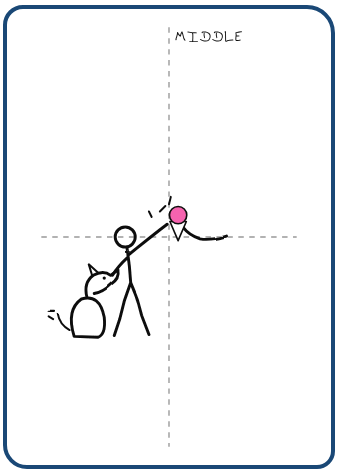
- Someone **waiting** in line
- Someone **working** or selling
- An **animal** doing its thing
- Something being **made**
- Something about to **happen**
- Two people **talking**



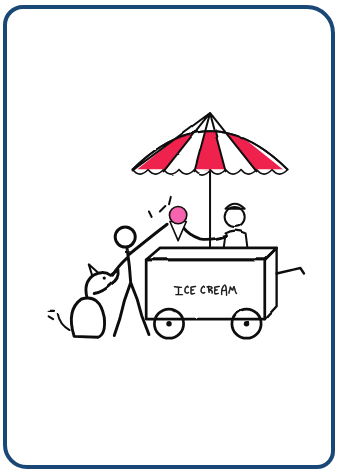
FRAME IT WITH YOUR FINGERS

Size check: your story moment should be about the size of your fist on the page. Smaller than that? Start over bigger.

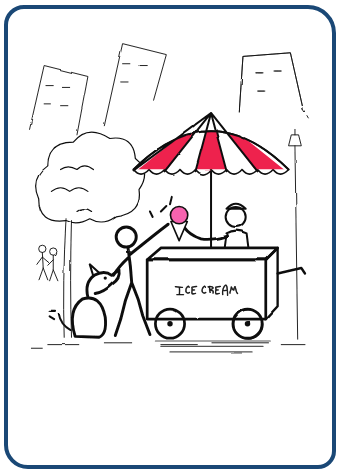
02 BUILD IT FROM THE CENTER OUT



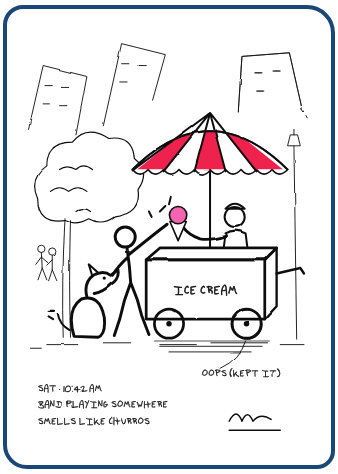
1 THE MOMENT
Big, in the middle. Thick lines.



2 BIG SHAPES
What's touching it? Add that next.



3 THE SETTING
Thin lines going out. Let the edges fade.



4 POPS + NOTES
2-3 colors, tiny text, sign it.

03 YOUR TIME

LOOK	→	INK	→	COLOR	→	NOTES
3 min sit, watch, pick the moment		20 min center out, pen only		10 min 2-3 watercolor pops		2 min time, place, sign it

04 HOW IT'S GRADED

- ☐ 2 pts **Story moment:** one clear subject, drawn big, near the middle.
- ☐ 2 pts **Center out:** a setting built around it, with edges that fade out.
- ☐ 2 pts **Ink:** pen only, thick close and thin far, people as gestures.
- ☐ 2 pts **Finish:** 2-3 color pops, notes or tiny text, and signed.